

Plan B Angling - lake rules rev 2.0 2025

“Member” shall refer to paid subscriber

“the club” shall mean Plan B Angling

“Facilities” shall mean anything owned by or on the property operated by the club

“the residents” shall mean the occupants and residential properties on Fornham road.

“day” is defined as 0700h - 1900h

“night” is defined as 1900h - 0700h

1. All individuals participating in angling at Bottom pond must comply with national rod license bylaws which can be found at <https://www.gov.uk/guidance/national-rod-fishing-byelaws-for-england-freshwater-fishing-with-a-rod-and-line> Or by searching for “fishing bylaws” in a search engine.
Members shall be held responsible for ensuring their guests are aware of, and are complying with, both the national fishing bylaws and club rules.
2. As a general principle, Plan B Angling will operate a “yellow / red” card policy with respect to its members and the breaking of the club rules. A yellow card may be issued for minor rule infringements. A red card will be issued for major rule infringements or if a yellow card has already been issued (and is in effect) following a previous rule infringement.
On receiving a red card your membership will be terminated and you will be asked to leave the club permanently.
A yellow card does not last indefinitely. The duration that the yellow card is in effect for will be determined by the club directors.
A record will be kept of all yellow cards issued.
3. Access gates must be kept closed and locked at all times to prevent non-member access and otter predation.
4. Members must not give out the gate code to anyone.
5. Members are permitted to bring family and friends as guests at no extra charge, however there are the following restrictions that should be observed;
 - 5.1. Guests of members are the responsibility of the hosting members, and their acts or omissions will reflect upon the hosting member.
 - 5.2. Members are asked to respect others at all times. Members are also asked that friends and family do not cause nuisance or disturb other members.
 - 5.3. Guests and members should not use more than two swims in total at the same time.
 - 5.4. Guests and members are not permitted to have more than four lines total in use at any one time.
This does not include marker rods or spods.
 - 5.5. Guests of members are not permitted to use the facilities without a hosting member being present at all times.
6. Parking must be away from the access gate on Fornham road. The space directly outside the gate may be used to drop off tackle only, prior to parking elsewhere. You may be asked to move your car, if you refuse you may be asked to leave the club.
7. Members must take home any rubbish created and not leave anything behind. It is expected that if members find rubbish from others that they also take this away at the same time.

8. Members are permitted to bring animals e.g. dogs, but animals must always remain under control. Any animal wastes must be cleaned up and taken away as rubbish.
9. Members are asked to respect other members and also the residents and not to cause nuisance e.g. loud phone calls, loud bite alarms, shouting, loud music or anti-social behaviour, fires etc.
10. Night fishing is permitted. The following conditions apply;
 - 10.1. Bite alarms (if used) should have volumes turned down to the minimum setting or ideally a remote receiver should be used.
 - 10.2. Any torches or other lighting used should be kept to a minimum and should be directed away from the residents' homes.
11. Only barbless or micro-barbed hooks are permitted.
12. Any line breaks, trailing rigs or snags are to be reported to the club directors as soon as possible.
13. Under no circumstance is a live bait to be used and any dead bait must come frozen from a shop. Home frozen baits are not permitted.
14. Any rods left unattended must be wound in and have bait removed. Unattended is defined as 'more than one peg or swim away'.
15. All fish should be returned to the water immediately after any weighing and photographing is complete, to minimise stress to the fish. "Catch and keep" is strictly prohibited.
16. Keep nets are permitted for most species provided they are "fish friendly" i.e. knotless and low abrasive with a 5 hour limit. All carp species should be released and NOT retained in any way unless explicit permission is granted by one of the club directors.
17. Use of unhooking mats is mandatory.
18. Entry into or onto the water is prohibited, this includes wading, use of boats or other floatation devices and swimming. Unless explicit written authorisation is obtained from one of the club directors. Written may be in the form of an SMS or other electronic message. e.g., WhatsApp, email etc.
19. Members and any guests found to be removing, harming or killing any fish will be reported and prosecuted under Operation Traverse. For more information, search "Operation Traverse".
20. Notices may be placed on or at the entry point to the lake. Members are obligated to read the information and heed as appropriate.
21. No fires permitted without obtaining prior consent of one of the club directors.
22. Use of portable barbeques is prohibited. We have provided BBQs, which may be used by members with an appropriate level of common sense. During summer months we may prohibit use of BBQs or other items that have a naked flame.
23. It would be appreciated if any photos and catch reports are posted to the private Facebook member group. In posting to the private group, you are giving consent for us to use the photos on our Facebook page or for other purposes.

24. Anglers use the facilities at their OWN RISK. The club does not accept any liability for injury to anglers or their guests, or theft, loss or damage to anglers' property.
25. Juniors (under 16) must always be accompanied by a responsible adult.
26. Tree climbing is prohibited for any reason.
27. Discrimination will not be tolerated.
28. Property of any kind may NOT remain at bottom pond without its owner being present unless by prior written consent of one of the club directors.
29. "Chair rule". To support our members who may or may not wish to be sociable or to engage readily with others, we are introducing the "Chair Rule" and this refers directly to the plastic garden type chairs Plan B have provided for free use. Please observe the following:
- If someone has a spare chair put out in their swim, then please feel free to stop and chat.
 - If they have a chair turned over face down, feel free to stop but be brief.
 - If there is no chair, then please move on and do not disturb.
30. No fishing is permitted behind the island on the south bank, including casting into it. See the attached picture for clarity. Red and white barrier chain marks the extent of the out of bounds area.
31. Any claims of record fish caught from Bottom Pond are to be verified by another member. A picture must also be taken and provided to the club, either by message, WhatsApp, email or other method. Claims without this verification will not stand.

Members found in breach of these rules may be banned from fishing Bottom Pond and disqualified from being a member with immediate effect and without refund. This extends vicariously to members' guests.

These rules will be reviewed periodically. The club reserves the right to amend the rules. Members will be notified prior to any changes. A copy of the latest rules will be available on request.

Ref: Rule 30 - Out of bounds area:

